

not download native software like Word, Powerpoint; instead these services can be used on a subscription basis.

Features:

Microsoft created web apps for all of their native applications which users can use as part of Office 365 subscription. The centralized panel which Office 365 provides is pretty simple, impressive and easy to use. The panel connects the users to SkyDrive, Word, PowerPoint, etc. Office 365 for Business has three different pricing plans and the following features:

Office Applications:

Microsoft Office applications that include Word, PowerPoint, Excel are till date the best on the globe and with every version of Office 365, users get the web applications of these products.

- ▶ Multiple editing on a single file is allowed.
- ▶ Real-time editing is not allowed. One cannot see in real-time the changes another author is making on a same document unless he/she saves it and stops editing. The part of the document being edited is locked from edit for all the other users.
- ▶ With desktop applications, files can be used and edited offline. Once the user goes online, SkyDrive automatically syncs all the versions on all devices.

Conferencing and IM:

- ▶ Office 365 allows users to do web conferencing by connecting to Lync.
- ▶ Skype users can also be invited.
- ▶ It provides standard IM service too.

Of course there are some more services such as MS Project etc but the ones above are the most important. Lets look at pros and cons now.

Pros:

- ▶ Files can be edited offline with the help of native desktop applications and synced with other versions online once online.
- ▶ Office applications like Word, Powerpoint and Excel are the best in terms of features when compared to any other applications in this domain.
- ▶ Better centralized panel where Newsfeed and other user activity can be tracked.